



Anywhere You Roam

A tale of laptops and PDA-phones: we tell you the best means to take your data and walk!

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There is something to be said about a world that expects you to carry your work with you, wherever you may be, whenever. As a digitally connected society, we are programmed to take blurred timelines, back-breaking roads, jetlag and virtual meetings in our stride, and sally forth to bring back that winning deal. While it is tempting to take a philosophical look at this state wherein “no time to stand and stare” is an accepted reality, such meanderings are best left to others.

So while the Deepak Chopras of the world address those issues through easily available paperbacks (perhaps as e-books readable on your PDA), we shall accept the status quo and make the best of it. We will, therefore, take a look at the best means of staying mobile with your precious data.

With mobility on our mind, our focus will be on two consumer devices—laptops and PDA-phones.

Did Someone Say Status Quo?

An interesting and recent development has been the proliferation of laptops in business houses, and to a lesser degree, within homes. These portable PCs are

currently powerful enough to carry out the most common tasks—writing and staying connected with peers and loved ones, while offering the necessary digital entertainment via movies and songs. The most important criterion here is, of course, portability, quickly followed by quick, convenient and safe retrieval of that portable data. Right now, laptops offer all this in an affordable package, and are quickly replacing desktop computers.

Going hand-in-hand with laptops are handhelds. Indeed, the competition on this turf for both size and features is so fierce that it has become quite a mental exercise to differentiate a phone from a ‘smartphone’,